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MADAN PILLUTLA
DEAN, ISB



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VARUN NAGARAJ
DEAN, SPJIMR

priority is to ensure that every ISB experience embodies the same excellence, rigour and brand integrity that defines the school,” he says.

WAY AHEAD

Unlike its flagship two-year programme, IIMA's Dubai campus will take the one-year route. According to Bhasker, a survey of the market at a middle and senior management level presented an opportunity where those with experience of five to seven years could be converted into professional managers. “A one-year programme will have a more immediate impact on Dubai's economy and establish our brand faster. People want to taste our product in a year across senior management positions,” he says.

IIM Mumbai (rechristened in 2023 after starting off as NITIE) is now looking to launch two new centres, in Navi Mumbai and Pune. A proposal has been submitted to the state government—the focus will be on finance and manufacturing. Each business school looks at the multiple campus expansion differently. S. P. Jain Institute of Management and Research (SPJIMR), for instance, has looked outside its Mumbai campus but only through the lens of executive education. “It's a more localised approach and we could do a weekend or a three-to-four-day programme,” says Dean Varun Nagaraj. The institute has been doing this in Delhi for seven years now.

Clearly, one size does not fit all and playing to one's strengths is a good idea. **BT**

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set up a campus,” he says.

It was the same story in Bhubaneswar, giving NMIMS a presence in the east. “Our objective is to ensure quality education reaches the doorstep of the student.” A multidisciplinary approach helps in creating an industry-relevant curriculum.

Multiple campuses present their own set of challenges, and getting the structure right is critical. In the case of NMIMS, there is one vice chancellor and one registrar, while each campus has a director. “All this results in high administrative efficiency in terms of having a lean system. The structure is leaner, and the number of layers is reduced.” NMIMS has 35,000 students across campuses and streams. “It is a centralised structure but highly decentralised as well,”

says Bhat. Not surprisingly, search for more opportunities continues, and he thinks there is a good chance that it will have ten campuses by 2030.

There is, understandably, a lot that goes into the process of setting up a new campus. For the Indian School of Business (ISB), that began in Hyderabad, the next stop was Mohali. Madan Pillutla, ISB's Dean, says Mohali was a “natural choice” with its strategic location, strong support from the Punjab government and active participation from industry leaders.

Equally, Pillutla makes it clear that the focus is on deepening the impact of what has been built, rather than expanding geographically. “Managing one school with two campuses is a complex endeavour and our